Specification of the controlled designation of origin "Graves"

approved by the order of 19 September 2025 published in the JORF of 21 September 2025

CHAPTER I

I. – Name of the designation

Only wines meeting the specific conditions set out below may claim the controlled designation of origin "Graves", initially recognised by the decree of 4 March 1937.

II. – Geographical denominations and complementary terms

No specific provision.

III. – Colour and types of product

The controlled designation of origin "Graves" is reserved for still red and white wines.

IV. – Areas and zones in which the various operations are carried out

1° – Geographical area:

The harvesting of the grapes, the vinification, the elaboration and the ageing of the wines are carried out within the territory of the following communes of the Gironde department, on the basis of the official geographic code dated 26 February 2020: Arbanats, Ayguemortes-les-Graves, Beautiran, Bègles, La Brède, Budos, Cabanac-Villagrains, Cadaujac, Canéjan, Castres-Gironde, Cérons, Cestas, Eysines, Gradignan, Guillos, Le Haillan, Illats, Isle-Saint-Georges, Landiras, Langon, Léogeats, Léognan, Martillac, Mazères, Mérignac, Pessac, Podensac, Portets, Pujols-sur-Ciron, Roaillan, Saint-Médard- d'Eyrans, Saint-Michel-de-Rieufret, Saint-Morillon, Saint-Pardon-de-Conques, Saint-Pierre-de-Mons, Saint-Selve, Saucats, Talence, Toulenne, Villenave-d'Ornon, Virelade, and on part of the territory of the commune of Coimères corresponding to section A known as des Herrères, 1st sheet of the cadastre (plan revised for 1934) certified as conforming to the conservation master plan at the date of 5 November 2010.

2° – Delimited parcel area:

The wines come exclusively from vines situated within the delimited parcel production area as approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the sessions of the competent national committee of 14 September 1989, of 8 and 9 November 1989, of 10 February 2011, of its standing committee of 4 September 2013 by delegation of the national committee, and of 11 February 2021.

The National Institute of Origin and Quality lodges with the town halls of the communes referred to in 1° the graphic documents establishing the parcel boundaries of the production areas thus approved.

3° – Immediate proximity area:

The immediate proximity area, defined by derogation for the vinification, the elaboration and the ageing, is made up of the territory of the following communes of the Gironde department, on the basis of the official geographic code dated 26 February 2020: Barsac, Béguey, Bieujac, Bommes, Cadillac, Fargues, Langoiran, Loupiac, Le Pian-sur-Garonne, Preignac, Rions, Saint-Loubert, Saint-Maixant, Saint-Pierre-d'Aurillac, Sainte-Croix-du-Mont, Sauternes and the part of the commune of Castets et Castillon corresponding to the territory of the former commune of Castets-en-Dorthe before its merger with Castillon-de-Castets on 1 January 2017.

V. – Grape varieties

1° – Grape varieties:

a) – Red wines. The wines come from the following varieties: cabernet franc N, cabernet-sauvignon N, carmenère N, cot N (or malbec), merlot N and petit verdot N.

b) – White wines. The wines come from the following varieties: muscadelle B, sauvignon B, sauvignon gris G, sémillon B.

VI. – Management of the vineyard

1° – Training methods:

a) – Planting density.
The vines present a minimum planting density of 5,000 plants per hectare. These vines may not present a spacing between rows greater than 2 metres, and a spacing between plants within the same row may not be less than 0.80 metre.

b) – Pruning rules.
Pruning is carried out at the latest by the spread-leaves stage (Lorenz stage 9). The vines are pruned according to the following techniques with a maximum of twelve free eyes (buds) per plant:

- so-called spur (cots or coursons) or cane (astes or long-wood) pruning;

- spur pruning to two cordons or four-arm fan training.

c) – Trellising rules and foliage height.
The height of the trellised foliage is at least equal to 0.60 times the spacing between rows. This height is measured from 0.10 metre below the bending wire up to the upper topping limit.

d) – Average maximum load per parcel.
The average maximum load per parcel is fixed at:

- 9,000 kilograms per hectare for vines intended for the production of red and dry white wines;

- 8,000 kilograms per hectare for vines intended for the production of white wines with residual sugars.

This load corresponds to a maximum number of fourteen bunches per plant. For the petit verdot N, sauvignon B and sauvignon gris G varieties, this maximum number is seventeen bunches per plant. Where irrigation is authorised in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 645-5 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, the average maximum load per parcel of the irrigated parcels is fixed at 7,500 kilograms per hectare.

e) – Threshold for missing vines.
The percentage of dead or missing vine plants provided for in Article D. 645-4 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is fixed at 20 %. Dead plants must be removed from the parcels; any storage of these dead plants on the parcels is prohibited.

f) – Cultivation condition of the vine.
The parcels are managed so as to ensure a good overall cultivation condition of the vine, in particular its sanitary condition and the upkeep of the soil. In particular, no parcel may be left abandoned.

2° – Other cultivation practices:

Before each new planting, every operator must carry out a physico-chemical analysis of the soil of the parcel in order to have all the information necessary to know the viticultural situation and its potential. Total chemical weeding of the parcels is prohibited. The permanent grassing of the contour of the parcels (headlands and non-planted or non-cultivated inter-parcel spaces) is compulsory. This obligation does not apply in the event of restoration of the headlands, in particular following erosion or exceptional climatic phenomena. Every operator calculates and records its treatment frequency index (IFT).

3° – Irrigation:

For the production of red and dry white wines, irrigation during the vine's growing period may be authorised, in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 645-5 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, only in the event of persistent drought and when this disturbs the good physiological development of the vine and the good ripening of the grape.

VII. – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes

1° – Harvest:

a) The red and dry white wines come from grapes harvested at proper ripeness. The white wines with residual sugars come from grapes harvested at over-ripeness (presence of noble rot and/or passerillage on the vine).

b) – Particular harvesting provisions. The white wines with residual sugars come from grapes harvested manually by successive tries (selective pickings).

2° – Ripeness of the grapes:

a) – Sugar content of the grapes. For the production of red and dry white wines, grapes with a sugar content of less than the following may not be considered to be at proper ripeness:

- 189 grams per litre of must for the merlot N variety and 180 grams per litre of must for the other black varieties;

- 178 grams per litre of must for the sauvignon B variety and the sauvignon gris G variety, and 170 grams per litre of must for the other white varieties.

For the production of white wines with residual sugars, grapes with a sugar content of less than 221 grams per litre of must may not be considered to be at proper ripeness.

b) – Minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume. The dry white wines present a minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume of 10.5 %. The red wines present a minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume of 11 %. The white wines with residual sugars present a minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume of 13.5 %.

c) – Minimum actual alcoholic strength by volume. The white wines with residual sugars present a minimum actual alcoholic strength by volume of 12 %.

VIII. – Yields. – Entry into production

1° – Yield:

The yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is fixed at:

- 55 hectolitres per hectare for the red wines;

- 58 hectolitres per hectare for the dry white wines;

- 40 hectolitres per hectare for the white wines with residual sugars.

2° – Limit yield:

The limit yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is fixed at:

- 65 hectolitres per hectare for the red wines;

- 68 hectolitres per hectare for the dry white wines;

- 48 hectolitres per hectare for the white wines with residual sugars.

3° – Entry into production of young vines:

The benefit of the controlled designation of origin may be granted to wines coming from:

- parcels of young vines only from the second year following that in the course of which planting was carried out in place before 31 July;

- parcels of young vines only from the first year following that in the course of which grafting in place was carried out before 31 July;

- parcels of vines that have been top-grafted, at the earliest in the first year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, and once the parcels no longer contain any varieties other than those permitted for the appellation. By way of derogation, in the year following that in the course

of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, the varieties permitted for the appellation may represent only 80 % of the grape varieties of each parcel concerned.

IX. – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage

1° – General provisions:

The wines are vinified in accordance with local, fair and constant usages.

a) – Reception and pressing. The harvest is cleaned by means of one or more techniques (destemmer, etc.).

b) – Malolactic fermentation. Malolactic fermentation is compulsory for the red wines. Every lot of red wine marketed (in bulk) or packaged presents a malic acid content less than or equal to 0.30 gram per litre.

d) – Analytical standards. Before packaging (bulk wines), the wines meet the following analytical standards:

ANALYTICAL PARAMETERS	**Red wines**	**Dry white wines**	**White wines with residual sugars**
Content of fermentable sugars (glucose and fructose) (grams per litre)	< 3	< 4	> 34
Maximum volatile acidity content (milliequivalents per litre or grams per litre expressed as acetic acid)	Until 31 July of the year following the harvest: 13.26 or 0.79 (0.65 g/l expressed as H2SO4) ---------- Beyond 31 July of the year following the harvest: 16.33 or 0.98 (0.80 g/l expressed as H2SO4)	13.27 or 0.80 (0.65 g/l expressed as H2SO4)	
Maximum total SO2 content (milligrams per litre)	140	180	

After packaging, the wines meet the following analytical standards:

ANALYTICAL PARAMETERS	**Red wines**	**Dry white wines**	**White wines with residual sugars**
Content of fermentable sugars (glucose and fructose) (grams per litre)	< 3	< 4	> 34
Maximum volatile acidity content (milliequivalents per litre or grams per litre expressed as acetic acid)		13.27 or 0.80 (0.65 g/l expressed as H2SO4)	25 or 1.5 (1.225 g/l expressed as H2SO4)

e) – Oenological practices and physical treatments.

- Subtractive enrichment techniques (SET) are authorised for the red wines within the limit of a concentration rate of 15 %;

- After enrichment, the dry white wines do not exceed a total alcoholic strength by volume of 13 %;

- After enrichment, the red wines do not exceed a total alcoholic strength by volume of 13.5 %;

- For the white wines with residual sugars, enrichment by dry sugaring or by rectified concentrated must may not have the effect of raising the total alcoholic strength by volume after enrichment beyond 15 %. Enrichment by partial concentration of the musts intended for the elaboration of wines is authorised within the limit of a concentration of 10 % of the volumes thus enriched. It may allow the total alcoholic strength by volume to be raised to a level of 19 % vol.

f) – Prohibited equipment. The use of the foulo-benne (self-emptying skip fitted with a so-called centrifugal paddle pump) is prohibited. The use of the dynamic drainer, of the continuous-type press (both fitted with an endless screw of a diameter less than 400 mm) is prohibited.

g) – Vat capacity. The minimum capacity of the vinification vat room is equivalent to 2 times the average ten-year yield of the holding multiplied by the area in production for the red wines, and 1.5 times the average ten-year yield of the holding for the white wines. The vinification capacity corresponds to the vinification containers, such as vinification vats and barrels.

h) – Overall upkeep of the cellar and equipment. The cellars are exclusively intended for the operations of vinification of the musts and/or storage of the wines. The cellar (floors and walls) and the vinification equipment present a good condition of upkeep and are at a sufficient level of hygiene.

2° – Provisions by type of product:

The red wines are aged at least until 15 April of the year following that of the harvest. The white wines with residual sugars are aged at least until 15 January of the year following that of the harvest.

3° – Provisions relating to packaging:

For each packaged lot, the operator keeps available for the defence and management body and for the approved control body:

- the information appearing in the register of handling operations referred to in Article D. 645-18 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code;

- an analysis carried out before packaging.

The analysis reports are kept for a period of six months from the date of packaging.

4° – Provisions relating to storage:

The operator demonstrates a place suitable for the storage of the packaged products. A suitable place for the storage of packaged products means any place sheltered from bad weather (wind, rain) and protected from any contamination.

5° – Provisions relating to placing on the market for the consumer:

The dry white wines are placed on the market for the consumer in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 645-17 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code. At the end of the ageing period, the red wines are placed on the market for the consumer from 1 May of the year following that of the harvest. At the end of the ageing period, the white wines with residual sugars are placed on the market for the consumer from 31 January of the year following that of the harvest.

X. – Link with the geographical area

1° – Information on the geographical area:

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link:

The geographical area of the controlled designations of origin “Graves” and “Graves supérieures” forms a band about ten kilometres wide on the left bank of the Garonne, from the north of Bordeaux to the south-east of Langon, skirting the enclave of the controlled designations of origin “Sauternes” and “Barsac”.

As the names of these controlled designations of origin indicate, the territory of the “Graves” is made up of pebbles, stones, gravels of greater or lesser coarseness, of sands mixed with silts and clays, resting in places on limestones but generally on pure sand or on alios (aggregated sands containing iron particles) or on clays. It extends over 42 communes of the Gironde department.

The soils of the “Graves” are the result of a long and complex geological history, closely linked to the birth of the Garonne, to the modifications of its course and to the successive glacial episodes of the Quaternary era. During these periods, the Pyrenean glaciers erode their valleys and prepare the rocky stocks that the rivers would then roll as far as the Bordeaux region. Of these successive deposits, only relics remain in the form of gravel knolls of all dimensions and of all types.

The soils that have since formed there have in common a great permeability due to their richness in gravels and pebbles. If they are not the only highly qualitative soils of the "Graves", they constitute their framework and the very image of excellence. Their slopes, by favouring the flow of the waters, are the guarantee of a perfect surface drainage. This drainage is moreover reinforced by an important hydrographic network of small watercourses, tributaries of the Garonne. These are soils where the water supply of the vine is very strongly regulated.

Protected from bad weather to the west by the pine forest playing an important thermoregulating role, from great heat and excess humidity by a natural aeration and ventilation due to the proximity of the Garonne, benefiting from the moderating oceanic influences on the spring frost, the vineyard of the "Graves" enjoys a particular and propitious climate.

The wine-growing landscapes of the Graves, made up of gentle slopes where the pale and polished stones reflect the light onto the grapes, are set between river and pine forests. This dense vineyard is dotted with châteaux and estates, architectural witnesses of the development of the region by wine-growing in all periods, since the Middle Ages. Towards the forest, the vineyard persists within clearings on pretty gravel knolls.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link:

The vine was established in the Gironde from Antiquity, at the gates of Bordeaux, in the region of the "Graves".

Archaeological excavations and the amphorae make it possible to date the first establishment to around 40 AD. However, the true wine-growing rise begins in the Middle Ages. At that time, the first vines are planted in the very heart of the city of Bordeaux and in its surroundings, on poor and stony lands unfit for any other crop.

In 1152, the marriage of Eleanor of Aquitaine with the king of England brings prosperity. This would rely on the granting to the "Banlieue" of the famous "Privilège" which prohibits any competition as long as a single barrel of town wine remains to be sold.

From the 16th to the 18th century, large estates devoted to the production of quality wines are constituted, wines that then appear under the name of "vins de Graves", a name considered as the Bordeaux wine par excellence. Exports towards England and the north of Europe are in full swing. The rating of the Graves then dominates the market until the end of the 18th century.

Overcoming the successive wine-growing crises of the 19th and 20th centuries linked to diseases (powdery mildew, downy mildew and phylloxera), to the winter frosts of 1956, to the surges of urbanisation of the Bordeaux and Langon conurbations, the economic renewal of the wines of Bordeaux begun in the 1970s fully benefited the region of the Graves, which recovers in the 2000s its historic area.

The black varieties, whose area has been in constant progression since the 1950s, today represent nearly two thirds of the areas of the vineyard. The controlled designations of origin "Graves" and "Graves supérieures" extend over nearly 5,000 hectares in 2010. Their annual production amounts to 160,000 hectolitres, that is about 21 million bottles of which three quarters in red wines. The remaining third is shared between the dry white wines (32,500 hectolitres) and the white wines with residual sugars (7,500 hl). The latter developed their renown throughout the 20th century and until the beginning of the 21st century under the name of the controlled designation of origin "Graves supérieures".

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the product:

The red wines come from a balanced set of grape varieties, where the cabernet-sauvignon N variety brings aromas and structure and the merlot N variety, perfume and suppleness, completed by the cabernet franc N, petit-verdot N, malbec N and carmenère N varieties. When they are young, they frequently develop aromas of red fruits accompanied by spicy and grilled notes. Elegant and structured, fine and aromatic, these wines evolve with harmony and their bouquet can then take on finely smoky notes. According to the vintages and their provenance, their peak is reached between 5 and 10 years.

The dry white wines are elegant and fleshy. Elaborated from the sémillon B variety, they generally develop floral notes as well as a natural richness that does not exclude freshness. When they are combined with the sauvignon B variety, which brings vivacity and expression, and with the muscadelle B variety which offers slightly musky notes, these wines often present aromas of flowers and citrus accompanied sometimes by exotic or menthol notes. Ageing in barrels, sometimes used, makes it possible to gain in richness and complexity after a few years of ageing.

The white wines with residual sugars, coming from grapes harvested at over-ripeness and picked by successive manual tries, are structured around the sémillon B variety. It offers round, ample wines, of a gold colour, with aromas of candied fruits. The possible blending with the sauvignon B variety and the muscadelle B variety brings freshness. Able to benefit from a few years of ageing, they can also be appreciated young.

3° – Causal interactions:

The original lands of great white wines and great red wines of the Bordeaux region, the region of the Graves is the cradle of practices still in use today. The varieties, cultivated under an oceanic climate, required, from the 17th and 18th centuries, supporting stakes, then the generalisation of trellising and a rigorous pruning method to ensure a good distribution of the harvest and a leaf surface sufficient for photosynthesis for an optimal ripeness.

In compliance with the usages already transcribed in the decree of 4 March 1937 defining the controlled designation of origin “Graves”, the delimited parcel area for the harvesting of the grapes classifies the parcels possessing the characteristic of a natural drainage either by their draining quality or by their position on a knoll or on a slope. Excluded are the geographical and topographic situations which, by their distance from the Garonne (loss of the thermal-regulation power of the river) or by their enclavement in the forest (blocking of the circulation of the cold air masses), are subject to spring frost.

The precisely delimited parcels allow the optimal expressions of the local varieties, selected over the course of history for their aptitudes for conservation and ageing, linked to the necessity of long-distance transport of these products.

The red wines must present a sufficient structure obtained by the optimal ripeness of the cabernet-sauvignon N variety and the merlot N variety, in particular on the stony, warm and not very fertile soils, naturally limiting production. These wines undergo an ageing necessary for their refining and their better expression before being placed on the market for the consumer.

The white wines coming mainly from the sauvignon B and sémillon B varieties draw their finesse and their floral and fruity expressions combined with the freshness from the sandier or clay-matrix soils.

In order to ensure a sufficient harvest, without overloading the vine plants, a guarantee of ripeness and optimal concentration of the fruit, the minimum planting density is high.

The conjunction of the proximity to the port of Bordeaux, where historically a powerful trade established itself to market these wines throughout the world, and of an original geo-pedological situation allowed the controlled designation of origin “Graves” to acquire an international renown.

This renown still endures. The human community pursues its efforts by improving the collective rules to promote the controlled designation of origin “Graves”, its heritage, and strives to have its personality and its name respected, which, an original sign, recall that of their soil.

XI. – Transitional measures

1° Training method:

a) Parcels of vines in place at the date of 31 July 2009 whose planting density is between 2,500 plants per hectare and 5,000 plants per hectare continue to benefit, for their harvest, from the right to the controlled designation of origin “Graves” until their grubbing-up and at the latest until the 2025 harvest included, subject to the operator complying with the following timetable:

- bringing 30 % of the areas concerned into conformity for the 2015 harvest;

- bringing 50 % of the areas concerned into conformity for the 2020 harvest.

The provisions relating to the trellising and foliage-height rules do not apply to these parcels, which present a minimum foliage height of 1.50 metre.

b) The provisions relating to the spacing between rows and to the spacing between plants within the same row do not apply to parcels of vines in place at the date of 31 July 2009 and whose planting density is greater than or equal to 5,000 plants per hectare. These parcels of vines continue to benefit, for their harvest, from the right to the controlled designation of origin “Graves” until their grubbing-up and at the latest until the 40th year following that of their planting (41st leaf).

XII. – Rules of presentation and labelling

1° – General provisions:

Wines for which, under the terms of the present specification, the controlled designation of origin “Graves” is claimed and which are presented under the said appellation may not be declared after the harvest, offered to the public, dispatched, put up for sale or sold unless, in the harvest declaration, in advertisements, on leaflets, labels, invoices and any containers whatsoever, one of the aforesaid controlled designations of origin is entered. From the 2026 harvest, the labelling of the wines includes the collective identifier in accordance with the provisions of the charter in force established by the Syndicat Viticole des Graves and made available to all operators.

2° Particular provisions:

a) The labelling of the wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin may specify the larger geographical unit “Vin de Bordeaux” or “Grand Vin de Bordeaux”. The dimensions of the characters of this larger geographical unit are not greater, both in height and in width, than two thirds of those of the characters composing the name of the controlled designation of origin.

b) The white wines are presented with the term corresponding to the content of fermentable sugars (glucose + fructose) present in the wine, as it is defined by Community regulations.

The white wines with residual sugars may be presented under the denomination “Graves supérieures” until the 2028 harvest.

CHAPTER II

I. – Declaration obligations

1° Prior declaration of parcel assignment:

Each operator declares before 31 July of the year of the harvest, to the defence and management body, the list of parcels assigned to the production of white wines with residual sugars. The declaration is renewable by tacit renewal, save for changes notified by the operator before 1 July preceding each harvest. This declaration specifies:

- the identity of the operator;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the cooperative cellar(s) to which he is, where applicable, a supplier;

- for each parcel: the cadastral reference, the area, the year of planting, the variety, the planting density or the spacings within the row and between rows.

2° Claim declaration:

The claim declaration is lodged with the defence and management body, at least fifteen days before the first departure of products from the vinification cellar and at the latest on 15 December following the harvest. It indicates:

- the colour and the type of wine claimed;

- the volume of the wine;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the name and address of the applicant;

- the place of storage of the wine.

It is accompanied by a copy of the harvest declaration and, as the case may be, a copy of the production declaration or an extract of the stock accounts for buyers of grapes and musts.

3° Prior declaration of removal or packaging:

Every operator wishing to move or package wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin "Graves" declares to the approved control body any bulk removal or packaging operation at least five working days before the operation.

Any operator who packages for more than one hundred days in the year is considered a continuous packager. This operator is exempt from the prior declaration for each operation but must send half-yearly a copy of the handling register to the approved control body.

Any operator who packages for between fifty and one hundred days in the year is considered a semi-continuous packager. This operator is exempt from the prior declaration for each operation but must send quarterly a copy of the handling register to the approved control body.

4° Declaration relating to the dispatch outside the national territory of a non-packaged wine:

Every operator wishing to carry out a dispatch outside the national territory of a non-packaged wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin "Graves" makes the declaration thereof to the approved control body within a period of ten working days minimum before the dispatch.

5° Fallback (repli) declaration:

Every operator marketing a wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin "Graves" under a more general appellation makes the declaration thereof to the defence and management body and to the approved control body within a period of five working days maximum before this fallback.

6° Downgrading declaration:

Every operator carrying out a downgrading of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin "Graves" makes the declaration thereof to the defence and management body and to the approved control body within a period of one month after this downgrading.

II. – Keeping of registers

Vines under transitional measures

Every operator concerned by the transitional provisions set at XI of Chapter I must keep available for the officers in charge of the control the inventory of the parcels concerned and the modifications made to these parcels, in particular by means of the copy of the declaration of completion of works in the event of grubbing-up and replanting.

CHAPTER III

I – Main points to be checked and evaluation methods

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
A. – STRUCTURAL RULES	
A1. – Belonging of the planted parcels to the delimited area.	Documentary check (up-to-date CVI record) and check in the field.
A2. – Claimable production potential (grape varieties and proportion rules, planting density	Documentary check and check in the field.

and trellising, transitional measures, abandoned vines).	
A3. – Processing, ageing, packaging and storage facilities.	
Reception: cleaning of the harvest.	On-site check.
Pressing (prohibited equipment).	On-site check.
Vinification / Ageing: vat capacity.	On-site check of vat capacity: total volume of the containers.
Specific storage place for packaged products.	Documentary check and on-site check (obligation of a covered place).
B. – RULES LINKED TO THE PRODUCTION CYCLE	
B1. – Management of the vineyard: abandoned vines, sanitary condition of the vineyard. — Pruning.	Counting of the number of free eyes (buds) per plant and description of the pruning method.
Average maximum load per parcel.	Counting of bunches and estimation of the load.
Cultivation condition of the vine.	Check at the parcel: criteria for analysis of the state of the vines: significant presence of woody plants other than the vine; significant presence of cryptogamic diseases.
B2. – Harvest and ripeness of the grapes. — Method of harvest (for white wines with residual sugars).	Random checks on the manual tries in the field.
Minimum sugar content of the grapes.	Checks in the field of compliance with the minimum sugar contents.
B3. – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage. — Oenological practices or treatments (enrichment, prohibited practices).	Documentary check and on-site check.
B4. – Harvest declaration and claim declaration. — Missing vines.	Documentary check (register keeping) and check in the field.
Authorised yield.	Documentary check (check of declarations, yield increase for certain operators [monitoring of the authorisations granted by the INAO services after enquiry by the said services upon individual request of the operator]).
VSI, volumes harvested in excess of the authorised yield.	Documentary check (monitoring of destruction certificates).
Claim declaration.	Documentary check and on-site check (compliance with the arrangements and deadlines, consistency with the harvest declaration, production declaration…). Control of the placing into circulation of the products.
C. – CHECKS ON THE PRODUCTS	
Non-packaged wines (at removal).	Analytical and organoleptic examination.
Packaged wines.	Analytical and organoleptic examination.
Non-packaged wines intended for a dispatch outside the national territory.	Analytical and organoleptic examination of all the lots.
D. – PRESENTATION OF THE PRODUCTS	
Labelling.	Documentary check and on-site check.

II – References concerning the control structure

National Institute of Origin and Quality (I.N.A.O)
TSA 30003,
93555 Montreuil Cedex,

telephone: (33) (0)1-73-30-38-00,
email: contact@inao.gouv.fr.

The control of compliance with the present specification is carried out on the basis of an approved control plan and by a third-party body offering guarantees of competence, impartiality and independence and having received delegation from the INAO. The control plan sets out the self-checks carried out by the operators on their own activity and the internal checks carried out under the responsibility of the defence and management body. It indicates the external checks carried out by the third-party body as well as the analytical and organoleptic examinations. All the checks are carried out by sampling. Non-packaged wines intended for a dispatch outside the national territory are the subject of a systematic analytical and organoleptic check.